



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Fort Worth
School Website: <https://chestertonacademyfw.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Fort Worth (CAFW) presents a robust classical-Catholic model that aligns strongly with the core Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Public-facing materials describe CAFW as a Catholic, independent classical high school that embeds truth, goodness, and beauty into a unified liberal-arts curriculum, emphasizes formation of character and virtue, and employs a Socratic, mail-strengthened pedagogy anchored by the Incarnation. The school explicitly places Catholic theology, liturgical life (including daily Mass), and a culture of life at the center of its mission, curriculum, and community life. The school also foregrounds architecture of community through a House system, active parent engagement, and a governance/advancement model that includes parent involvement and regular communications with families.

Key evidence from CAFW materials includes: "an independent classical high school in the Catholic tradition... Grounded in the Truths of the Catholic Faith" and "By introducing them to great thinkers such as Socrates, Thomas Aquinas and Dante, and by forming them in a distinctly Catholic culture" (public materials). The curriculum is described as classical and integrated, braided humanities across theology, history, literature, philosophy, languages, and the sciences, with explicit notes that the humanities use a Socratic Method. The school's mission centers on forming joyful leaders and saints within a Culture of Life; three pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) guide program design; daily Mass and Catholic formation are part of faculty and student life. The leadership and faculty sections describe named leaders and a living-curriculum ethos, and there is explicit emphasis on parent partnership and open campus/community engagement.

Overall category-by-category snapshot indicates CAFW is CLASSICAL across all six categories. The public materials explicitly reference religious foundations, formation-focused purpose, liberal-arts curriculum with classical content, Socratic pedagogy, a living/fixed faculty ethos, and strong parent/community partnerships. Therefore, the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL.

Abstracted takeaways: - Strengths: Clear religious-metaphysical grounding in Catholic faith; explicit formation aims (virtue, wisdom, goodness, beauty); liberal-arts curriculum with classical spine; Socratic pedagogy and full upper-year humanities integration; vowed Catholic identity within faculty culture; active parent/community involvement. - Needle-moving opportunities: None required at the aggregate level given the CLASSICAL classification, though ongoing alignment checks with the Great-Conversation canon and expanded public articulation of Great-Books selections could further reinforce the curricular fidelity.

Citations note: The assessment draws on CAFW site content describing Catholic identity, culture of life, and classical curriculum (e.g., canonical statements and sections such as "High School with a Higher Purpose," "Our Curriculum," "The Humanities Program," "A Focus on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty," "Daily Mass," "House System," and faculty/board communications). See specific citations to the CAFW content sources embedded in the category sections below. See also explicit alignment with the Six Essential Elements lexicon in the accompanying knowledge documents.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CAFW identifies itself as a classical high school “in the Catholic tradition” and emphasizes Catholic formation as foundational (Grounded in the Truths of the Catholic Faith; Catholic culture; daily Mass) . - Public materials emphasize a culture of life and formation toward virtue and joy in a Catholic framework, with references to Incarnation-focused curriculum and a sacramental worldview (Incarnation; catechesis; liturgical life) . - Materials describe the school as forming students to be “joyful saints,” linking virtue and spiritual formation to the overall educational project (formation of character; three pillars: Intellect, Character, Spirituality) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic, truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, Mass, Incarnation, sacred, sacred music (chant), worship, catechesis, logos, wisdom, virtue, Catholic culture. - Negative keywords: None detected in the public materials (no signals of relativism, secular humanism, value-neutrality, or workforce-primacy in this category).

Why this rating - The public materials foreground transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Catholic-metaphysical frame, with liturgical life and Catholic formation interwoven into daily school life. This aligns strongly with the Classical Education ideal of transcendentals and theological grounding, yielding a CLASSICAL rating for this category. The explicit Catholic liturgy and sacramental framing anchor this category in a distinctly metaphysical-religious foundation. See evidence above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission statement centers on forming “joyful leaders and saints” within a classical-Catholic framework, not primarily workforce preparation; emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing (Culture of Life; formation over information) . - The Three Pillars—Intellect, Character, Spirituality—and the goal of helping students “choose for themselves the adventure of being a disciple of Christ” reflect formation-oriented aims beyond job prep . - The public materials frame education as formation in human excellence, virtue, and wisdom, rooted in truth and beauty, rather than mere information transfer or credential attainment .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, contemplation (Scholé), great conversation, human excellence, soul craft. - Negative keywords: industry/job preparation terms are not foregrounded; no explicit emphasis on workforce-readiness as primary outcome.

Why this rating - The stated goals emphasize formation and virtues rather than career training, with explicit reference to truth, goodness, beauty and human flourishing. The presence of a clearly articulated telos and a formation-centered mission supports CLASSICAL. The explicit “Culture of Life” framing and the three-pillar approach further reinforce formation-centric aims. See evidence above.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Humanities-focused, integrated liberal-arts approach is stated; history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages braided together in an integrated curriculum; use of the Socratic Method. Public materials also describe a historic progression through ancient world to modern world; inclusion of Latin and math/science strands as part of a classical curriculum . - The materials explicitly reference “great thinkers” (Socrates, Aquinas, Dante), and readings spanning Homer, Dante, Shakespeare, Chesterton, Dostoevsky, etc., signaling engagement with canonical Great Books and the Great Conversation. The humanities sequence and canonical literature selections (Homer, Canterbury Tales, Dante, Shakespeare, etc.) are documented in CAFW materials □filecite□turn2file13t statements about a focus on the Incarnation, theology, and sacred texts within Theology, and a required Latin study program as part of the language curriculum, with track options in math/science also described .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric (in the lexicon-supported framing of classical education), Great Books, Latin, history, philosophy, theology, sacred

texts, Latin, Socratic Method, Incarnation, the great conversation. - Negative keywords: minimal presence of project-based learning dominance; no social studies substitution for history; no emphasis on value-neutral, utilitarian curricula.

Why this rating - CAFW materials explicitly frame the curriculum as classical and liberal-arts oriented, with canonical readings, Socratic method in humanities, and classical languages, consistent with the six-element framework for grammar/logic/rhetoric and Great Books/Great Conversation. The presence of Latin, history through a classical lens, and integration across disciplines support a CLASSICAL rating. See evidence above. □filecite□turn2file11agogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL (with strong Socratic/Scholé elements)

Evidence - The Humanities Program explicitly notes the use of the Socratic Method for integrating history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages, a hallmark of classical pedagogy. This is a core teaching-method signal for CAFW's classroom approach. - CAFW emphasizes a house-system and virtue-building practices (e.g., daily Mass attendance, spiritual retreats) that shape pedagogy around formation and communal life; there is a stated commitment to memory through teaching methods (chant, recitation) in classical tradition (as reflected in broader Chesterton canon materials and related notes about classical pedagogy in the lexicon). Public materials show a combination of contemplative/restful elements with active, dialogic discussions in upper grades (Socratic/seminal pedagogy signals) via the integrated humanities, and the overall classical pedagogy aims (house-system and ritual elements for memory and formation) □filecite□turn1file6□f a “fully integrated classical curriculum centered on the Incarnation” and inclusion of a variety of performance/arts activities supports a pedagogy that blends contemplative and rigorous elements with communal and liturgical rhythms.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic Method, Great Books/Great Conversation, liberal arts (grammar/logical/rhetoric), incarnation/sacramental approach, chant, memory work, rhetoric, eloquence, discussion/seminar, formation through pedagogy. - Negative keywords: the public materials show little to no emphasis on “project-based only,” “experiential-learning domination,” or “constructivist-only” approaches. In fact, the opposite signals (Socratic seminars and memory work) are foregrounded.

Why this rating - The explicit use of Socratic dialogue in humanities, combined with integrated classical pedagogy and contemplative elements (Scholé-like restfulness and memory-focused recitation) align with CLASSICAL pedagogy criteria. The presence of chant and liturgical integration adds to the contemplative aspects of pedagogy. See evidence above.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials name the Headmaster and a slate of faculty with defined roles and bios (e.g., Headmaster Steven Barmore; faculty directory that lists teachers for Literature, Math, Science, History, Choir, etc.). The faculty tradition is described as a living curriculum and a model for students. The Headmaster's background and appointment context are described (e.g., co-founder, Catholic/academic background). - The Chesterton model often emphasizes a living curriculum and a faculty-curriculum alignment (the “faculty as living curriculum” notion is embedded in Chesterton networks; CAFW materials emphasize a close-knit, virtue-driven, teacher-led environment). The job postings emphasize Catholic classical education and fidelity to Magisterium, indicating expectations for faculty who model virtue and mastery of classical content areas (Latin, literature, theology). - Public communications show ongoing professional engagement with classical-education networks (e.g., Board Leadership Training and connections with UD) suggesting a faculty development culture aligned with classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: master teachers/mentors, living curriculum, faculty as core of the school, collegiality/friendship among faculty, mentorship, fidelity to Magisterium, daily Mass participation, formation of character within the faculty. - Negative keywords: none detected (no signals of a purely performative or non-classical faculty structure).

Why this rating - CAFW's published materials present a clearly identified leadership and faculty structure rooted in Catholic classical formation, with explicit ties between faculty identity and the school's mission. The

presence of named leaders, biographical details, and a focus on virtue exemplars aligns with CLASSICAL faculty expectations. See evidence above.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CAFW communications emphasize partnerships with families and parent involvement (newsletter communications, board newsletters, and fundraising communications noting parent engagement). The Church/parent partnership is a staple of Chesterton Schools Network communications; CAFW materials describe parent involvement in information sessions, fundraising, and events. Open-house events and family-oriented activities are featured on the site, along with opportunities for parent participation and campus visits . - Admissions and fundraising materials show a family-centered approach, with guidance for parents, information sessions, and volunteer/fundraising participation; the Board communications emphasize that “culture matters” and invite parent engagement and prayers, reflecting partnership with families as co-educators . - The network communications emphasize parent formation and home-school alignment, which are explicit in classical-education lexicon (e.g., discussions of parent education book studies and classical-parent engagement; “parents as co-teachers” in the lexicon). CAFW materials show a consistent pattern of parent involvement and events designed to welcome parents on campus .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, parent formation/education, open campus/visits, parent engagement, home-school/community rhythm, invitation to parish life and family events. - Negative keywords: None detected in these CAFW materials.

Why this rating - CAFW's materials foreground active parent partnership, community events, and ongoing opportunities for parent involvement, reflecting the “Parent Partnerships” and “Community” signals highlighted in the Six Essential Elements. See evidence above.

Aggregate Assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle - Not required given the CLASSICAL aggregate rating. If one wanted to further strengthen the profile, CAFW could continue to publicly catalog and publish exemplar Great Books lists and explicit connections to the Great Conversation across grades, and continue to document concrete examples of Socratic seminars, memory-work rituals, and public rhetoric opportunities (e.g., student speeches, debates) to provide even more explicit alignment with the Six Elements.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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